Sound Design Progress

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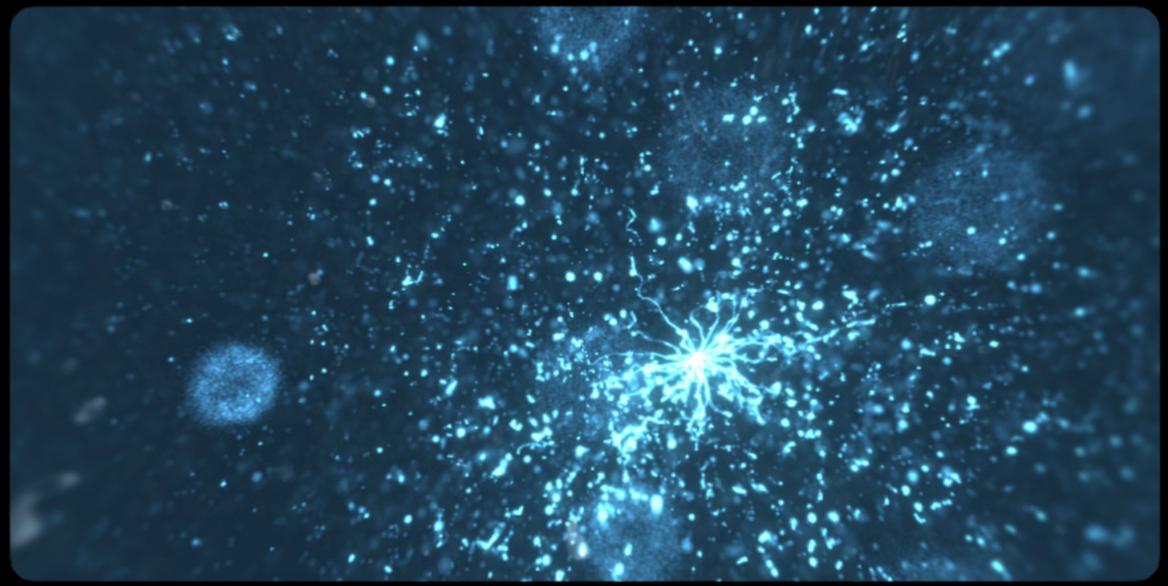
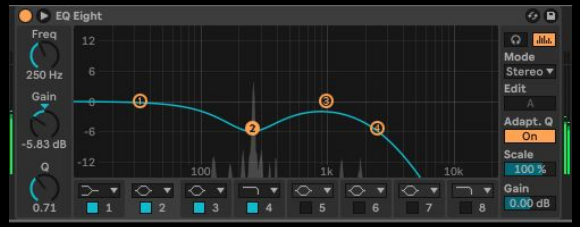
Generative Design and Ableton Live

Utilising Ableton Lives inbuilt connectivity with TouchDesigner, I am able to create sound that reacts and engages with my art in real time.

As my work is inspired by micro-landscapes and the unseen world of life at its smallest form, I am presented with the challenge of imagining how these environments sound.

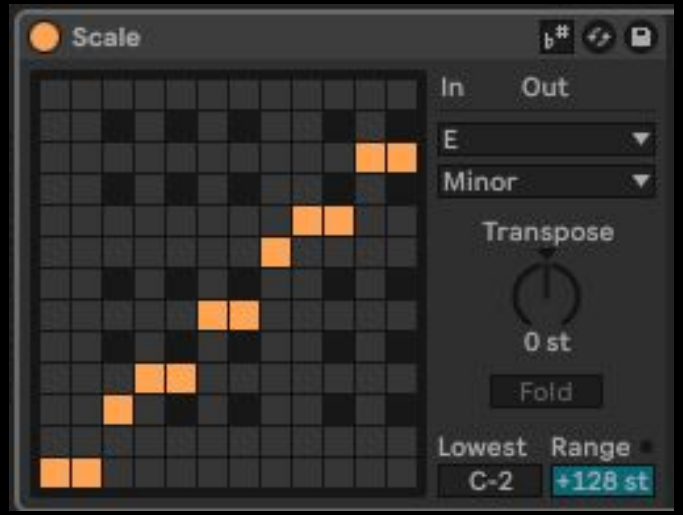


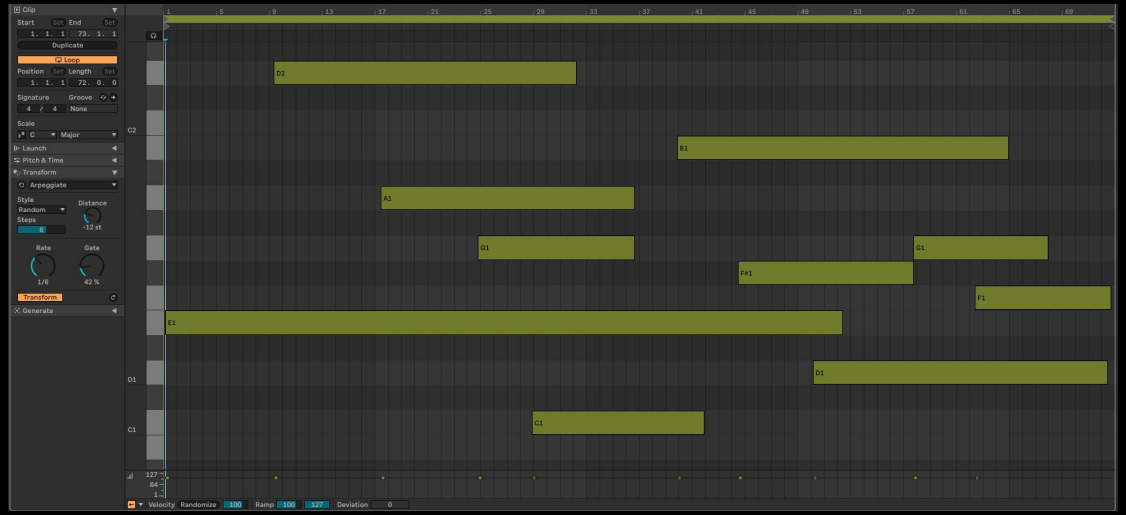
Generative Synth and Atmospheric Sound



Ableton has very user friendly stock instruments which have a variety of presets.

I tend to start by exploring a preset I find interesting, adjust parameters to my liking, then apply effects and other sound design techniques to add depth and texture to each element.





Ableton has the ability to snap any pressed key to a desired musical scale. This allows me to easily create melodies which are in the same key without having to know which keys to press. I click record, and play randomly using my laptop keyboard. This create a random sequence, but sounds coherent. This process of free flowing generation allows me to give more attention to the sound design elements without having to teach myself musical theory to create humanised musical melodies.

I tend to record really long melodies because this allows people to forget when it began/end. This helps in making the sequence sound like it is continuously changing and developing.

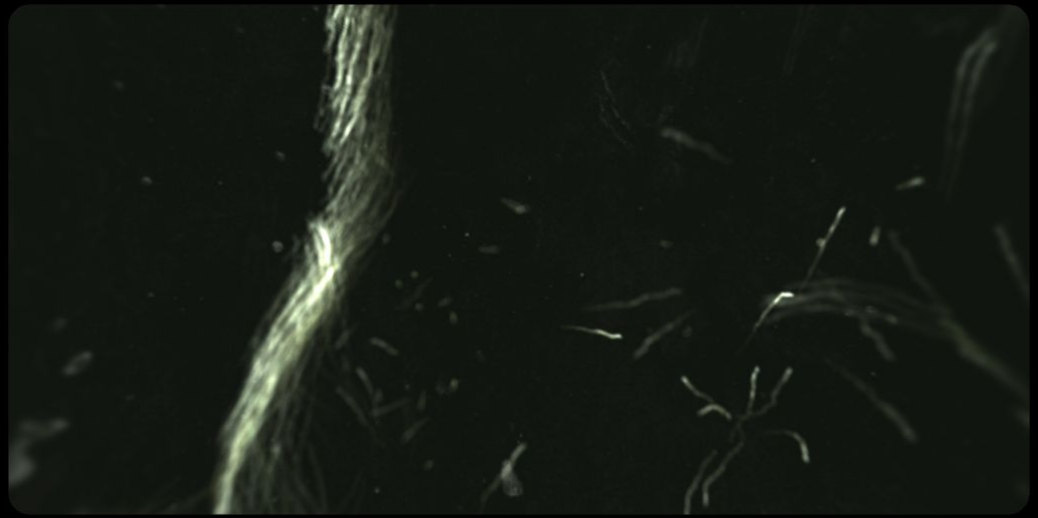
This, in combination with modulated effects using LFO's, the generative nature of this sound becomes increasingly complex.

Ensuring a clean mix is crucial in my process. Ensuring all channels are working together nicely with appropriate EQ, gain and compression elements, provides sonic coherence and nothing seemingly out of place, too loud, or too quiet, while still having dynamics throughout the mix.

In terms of mastering, I try out all the different ableton mastering presets to see which one emphasises my composition the most, then make minor changes from there. Again, minimising the amount of time spent on the nitty gritty stuff allows me to focus on the wider picture and forefront sound design elements. As my project will be presented in a specific room, I am looking to further tweak the mix down inside the space itself, as the nature of the room will have a large impact on how the project sounds in comparison to the monitors im using at home.

Whats Next

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=db0BE0AWqIE

This draft is showcasing the implementation of sound design into my work. At the moment this only has 4 designs, however the final will have quite a few more, each with their own sound.

Over the next few weeks, I will continue creating unique sound design for each different design, whilst possibly implementing feedback sound for user interaction.